

Praneeth Reddy Mandalapu

669-282-5395 | praneethreddymandalapu@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | Santa Cruz/Sacramento, CA

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz <i>Bachelor of Science in Computer Science</i> - Undergraduate Dean Award Scholarship recipient Relevant Coursework: CSE 30 (Python), CSE 12 (Assembly), CSE 16 (Discrete Math), MATH 23A (Vector Calculus), CSE 13S - C Programming, CSE 101 Data Structures & Algos (Fall 2026)	Santa Cruz, CA Sept. 2025 – May 2029
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EXPERIENCE

Automation Intern <i>California Department of Motor Vehicles</i> - Working on automating internal DMV workflows to improve operational efficiency - Researching applications of large language models (LLMs) to streamline and support internal processes	Summer 2026 – Present Remote
LLM Performance Reviewer <i>Handshake</i> - Reviewing and benchmarking frontier Large Language Models (ChatGPT, Claude, Copilot) for response accuracy and logic - Applying prompt engineering techniques to evaluate model performance and identify hallucination patterns - Providing structured feedback on model outputs to support the deployment of reliable AI-driven solutions	Jan. 2026 – Present Remote
Data Team Member <i>Formula Slug (UCSC FSAE)</i> - Developing predictive models to analyze battery thermal output for electric vehicle performance optimization - Performing data cleaning, preprocessing, and feature engineering on high-frequency sensor datasets using Python - Collaborating with multi-disciplinary teams to document findings and integrate data-driven insights into hardware iterations	Sept. 2025 – Present Santa Cruz, CA
Engineering Intern <i>PeopleSense.ai</i> - Gained hands-on experience in flashing and deploying IoT devices for real-world public space installations - Documented device deployment workflows and presented performance findings to the engineering team	May 2024 – Dec. 2024 Sacramento, CA

PROJECTS

SlugSync – Best UI/UX Award <i>React, Firebase, Python, Devpost</i> - Developed a campus event tracking application that won Best UI/UX for its intuitive design and seamless user flow - Implemented frontend features to streamline event discovery and engagement for the student body - Project documentation and demo available at: devpost.com/software/slugsync	Oct. 2025
Custom Subwoofer Engineering <i>Acoustic Modeling, CAD, Fabrication</i> - Researched, designed, and fabricated a custom high-performance subwoofer featured on PartsExpress.com - Analyzed frequency response data to optimize enclosure design for superior acoustic output	2024

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & Machine Learning: LLM Benchmarking (Claude, ChatGPT, Copilot), Prompt Engineering, Predictive Modeling
Data Science: Python (Pandas, NumPy, Polars), Data Preprocessing, Feature Engineering, Tableau
Tools & Frameworks: Git, VS Code, Firebase, IoT Deployment, MSCOCO
Soft Skills: Technical Documentation, Cross-functional Collaboration, Problem-solving

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

Best UI/UX Award: SlugSync (UCSC Hackathon)
SkillsUSA State Semifinalist: Internet of Things (IoT)
Safety Certified: Approved for laboratory operations at Slugworks Lab